

Optimization of a UAV for Wildfire Management

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(ABSTRACT)

Give a brief description of your thesis here.

Optimization of a UAV for Wildfire Management

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(GENERAL AUDIENCE ABSTRACT)

You are also required as of Spring 2016 to include a general audience abstract. This should be geared towards individuals outside of your field that may be reading seeking information about your work. You should avoid language that is particular to your field and clearly define any terms that may have special meaning in your discipline.

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NLP is a field of computer science, artificial intelligence, and linguistics concerned with the interactions between computers and human (natural) languages.

σ is the eighteenth letter of the Greek alphabet, and carries the 's' sound. In the system of Greek numerals, it has a value of 200.

Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 One Section

1.1.1 A sub-section

1.2 Another Section

Chapter 2

Review of Literature

Chapter 3

UAV Design

3.1 UAV Geometry

The UAV is modeled as a simplified octocopter frame. [Talk about original UAV design??? [reference???]] The UAV geometry is shown in figure 3.1 - figure 3.3 with the UAV frame components highlighted. The frame model contains 3 components: the arms, the struts, and the hubs. The arms and struts are both beams with annular cross sections. The hub is two octagonal plates connected with a web shown in figure ???. The hub model is an simplification, as it can not fit the entire battery within the bounds of hub. Further work can be done to create a more detailed model.

The hub has 3 design variables, the web thickness, the circumscribed hub radius, and the thickness of the plates. Figure [ref] shows the design variables is [figure showing DVs] The hub height is a parameter set to 64mm as to fit the with UAV battery. [citation needed]

The arm beams span from the faces of hub to the wingspan. The design variables are thickness and radius. The wingspan is 1127.3mm. It is the minimum length required to fit all 8 propellers with a radius of [440mm??] and a propeller spacing of 25mm.

The strut beams have 3 design variables, thickness, radius, and, the distance from the hub center to the arm end. Strut deign variables are shown in figure [XYZ fig].

The UAV carries a payload of 45kg. All frame components are made from carbon fiber with

material properties shown in table [ref XYZ]. [DO I CITE EMAIL? CITATION NEEDED]

From these design variables relevant cross-section properties are calculated.

The drone batteries are also have a mass of [mass] and dimensions of [dimension]

The DroneGeometry class within the UAV_Geometry module stores relevant design variables for a drone geometry. The relevant coordinates for hub, arm, and struts are calculated.

The projected surface area for drag calculation a drone geometry is calculated using the calc_projected_surfac_area method. [talk about this in detail later]

3.2 Mission Profile

A model of the mission profile was created to describe a potential mission with continuous position, velocity, and acceleration with respect to time. The mission profile is modeled as a series of mission profile segments. Constraints are put on the position, velocity, and acceleration at the nodes between mission profile segments. The remaining values at the nodes are calculated using basic kinematic equations. At values of time between mission segment nodes, the position, velocity, and acceleration are interpolated using cubic Hermite splines. [citation needed] Acceleration changes linearly with respect to time.

The mission profile is based on a potential mission during the 2025 Palisades wildfire. The distance for the mission profile is estimated to be 5600m, the distance from the north edge of the active fire area to south edge of the wildfire. Using elevation maps of the surrounding area, the height required to transverse this mission path is 460m. [cite map] Timeesteps were set so that maximum x-velocity to be under 12m/s. [cite nick thesis?]

The climb, cruise, and descent periods are each described using two separate cubic Hermite spline intervals to prevent over-defining the mission profile. Figure 3.5 shows the altitude

for the mission profile against the down range position. Figure 3.6 shows the altitude over time. Figure 3.7 shows the downrange position with respect to time. Table 3.1 shows the constraints on the mission profile. The duration shows the time between spline intervals. Blank entries are where no constraint was applied.

Table 3.1: Mission Profile Constraints

Segment	Initial	Takeoff	Climb 1	Climb 2	Cruise 1	Cruise 2	Decent 1	Decent 2	Land
Duration (s)	N/A	12	10	10	25	25	10	10	15
Position X (m)	0			550	1250	2000			2400
Position Y (m)	0			100	105	110			0
Velocity X (m/s)	0								0
Velocity Y (m/s)	0								0
Acceleration X (m/sec ²)	0			0		0			0
Acceleration Y (m/s ²)	0			0		0			0

Mission profiles are generated with a mission_profile module. This module contains a MissionProfile class, MissionProfileSegment class, and the kinematic matrix function. The MissionProfile contains a list of constraints added by the add_constraint method, and a list of segment durations added by the add_segment method. It also contains the solve_kinematics and time_solve method. The solve_kinematics method assembles matrixes generated from the kinematic_matrix function into a kinematic matrix for the entire mission profile. The remaining position, velocity, and acceleration values at the nodes are then calculated using the numpy.linalg.lstsq function. The time_solve method uses a cubic Hermite spline to find interpolate values at a given time.

3.2.1 Thrust Calculation

A calculation of the thrust profile is required in order to preform the power and fatigue analysis.

The thrust equation over the duration of the mission profile is shown below. Both the acceleration and drag forces are considered.

$$F_{\text{thrust}}(t) = + - v(t)^2 * s_a * \rho * c_d + (a(t) + g) * m$$

The $v(t)$ and $a(t)$ represent the velocity and acceleration of the mission profile at given point in time.

s_a is an estimate of the surface area of UAV. This is obtained by summing the projected surface of every beam and hub segment with the projected surface area of the two batteries. It is a function of thee design variables.

$\rho = 1.2250\text{kg m}^{-3}$ is the air density. $c_d = 0.256$ is the drag coefficient. [How to justify?] $g = 9.8066\text{m s}^{-2}$ was used for the gravity constant.

The mass is estimated as the sum of 45kg payload, the mass of the frame, and the mass of the two batteries.

To simulate the pre-liftoff, and post-landing period, a rev up and rev down period were added to the thrust forcing function. This was modeled as a linear increasing force with respect to time up until the force required for take off for the rev up period. The rev down period was modeled as a linearly decreasing force until no force is applied. A duration of 5 seconds was selected for both periods.

[include plot of thrust function]

3.3 UAV Power

A model of the drone power system was developed to describe the power demand of the vehicle throughout the mission. The trust at a given time is converted to power based on

experimental data. [CITE] This is interpolated as a quadratic function. This allows the power draw to be calculated at any point during the mission. The power over the thrust profile is integrated over time to obtain energy consumed. [Cite? Has anyone else done this? Idk?]

Equation 3.3 shows the resulting thrust to power requirement.

$$P(t) = 0.01238T(t)^2 + 0.03214T(t) + 0.06548$$

[plot of power]

The batteries in the design are two "Tattu 40000mAh 6S 10C 22.8V High Voltage UAV Lipo Battery Pack with AS150+AS150 Plug" [I don't know how to format this] They have 40000mah and supply 22.8 volts of power.

The percent throttle function is calculated as a power required divided by the power required for maximum throttle. P_{max} is 16kW. [According to what? Cite paper? Justification please?]

$$T_{percent}(t) = P(t)/P_{max}$$

[plot of percent throttle]

Power calculations are done with the DronePower class within the drone_power module. The class takes battery data, the thrust profile, and a timestep as inputs to calculate the consumed energy and power consumption over the duration of the mission. The integral of the power is calculated using `scipy.integrate.cumulative_trapezoid` to find the energy

consumed.

3.3.1 Oscillation Calculation

For the transient damage analysis a model of oscillations caused by propeller perturbations was also required. This as modeled as a force over time. The desired function is a sinusoidal wave with a frequency matching the propeller frequency. The amplitude was estimated to be 1% of the thrust. Equation ?? shows the completed equation for the perturbation forcing function. ω_{max} is the maximum angular velocity of the propeller.

$$F_{\text{perturbation}}(t) = 0.01 \sin(\omega_{max} T_{percent}(t) t) F_{\text{thrust}}(t)$$

[Plot of perturbation graph?]

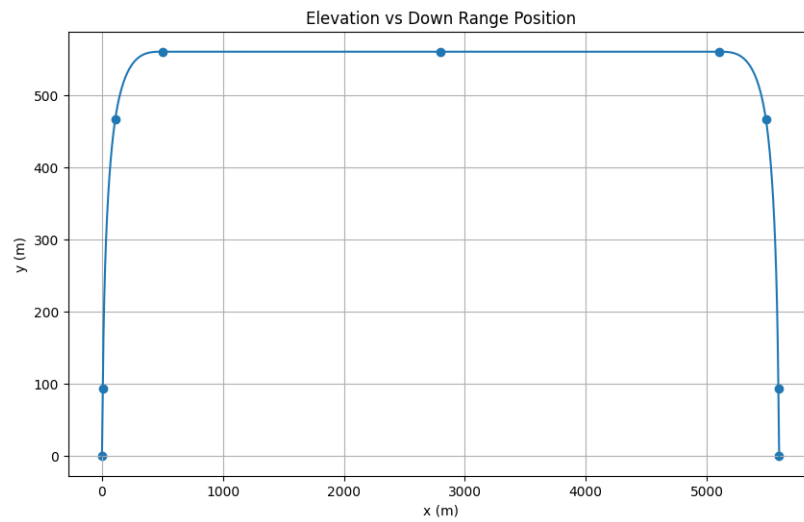


Figure 3.5: Downrange Position vs. Altitude

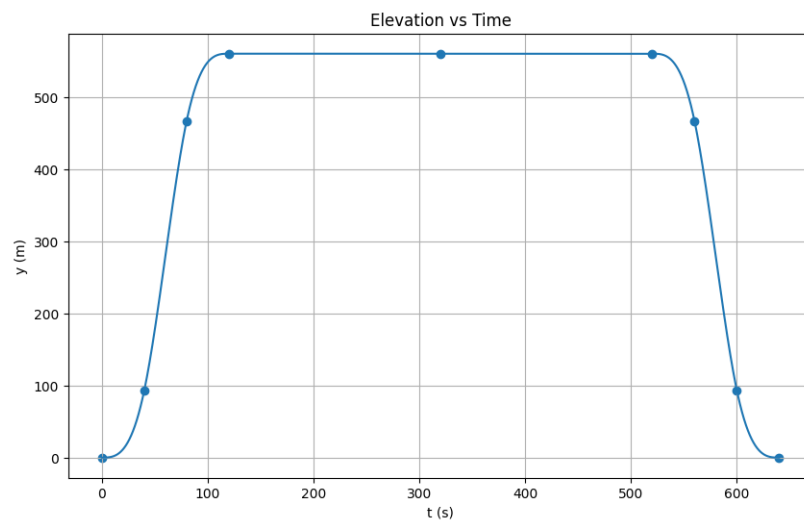


Figure 3.6: Altitude vs. Time

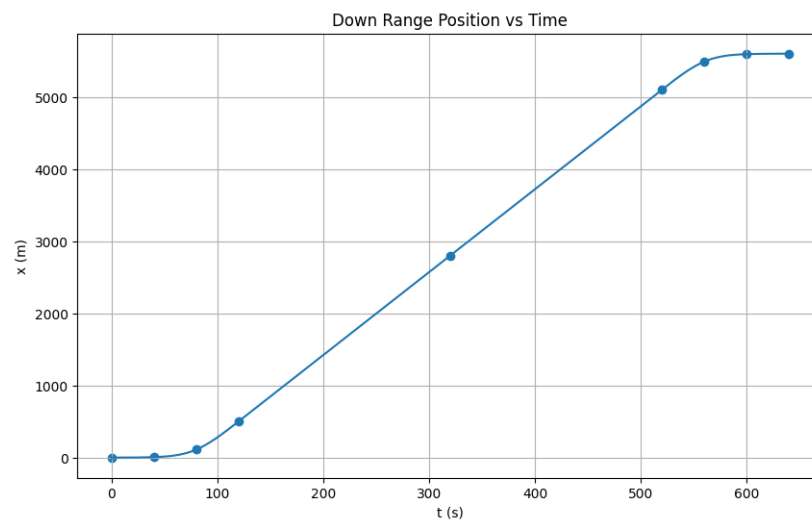


Figure 3.7: Downrange position vs. Time

Chapter 4

Finite Element Analysis

A finite element model was created to be run repeatedly by the optimization algorithm. The finite element model is designed so that it can be easily adapted for different frame models

- Describe the matrix assembly process? (mass and stiffness)

The finite element model is divided into several different modules. The `beam_system` module contains the `BeamSystem` class. The `beam_type` module contains `BeamType` class which stores beam cross section and material definitions. The `beam_element` module contains information about each beam element in the `BeamElement` class. The `node` module contains the `Node` class.

A material property dictionary is stored in `material_properties` module. Cross section properties are calculated using functions in the `cross_section_properties` module.

The `BeamSystem` class contains list of `BeamElement` objects and a list of `Node` objects. The `BeamElement` object. Each `BeamElement` object references a `BeamType` object. The `BeamType` object stores the material properties retrieved from the `material_module`. The cross section properties are calculated for a given cross section using functions within the `cross_section_properties` module.

Nodes are added using the `add_node` method in the `BeamSystem` class. The nodes contain a single position in the global coordinate system.

Beam elements are added to the BeamSystem class using the add_beam method. The add_beam method requires a reference to a start and an end node, a BeamType object and a k node to determine the orientation of the beam's cross-section.

The boundary conditions are added with the add_boundary_condition method. The method requires the value of the boundary condition, the boundary condition type (x, y z, x rotation, ect.), and node reference here the boundary condition is applied.

The solve_FEA method solves the stiffness and mass matrixes for the given system. The solve_static, solve_dynamic_harmonic, and solve_transient methods find the solution for given forces.

4.1 Beam Element Formulation

Beams are modeled as timeshenko beams elements with 12 degrees of freedom [citation needed?]. This beam model takes shear deformation effects into account. The mass for each beam is modeled as a 3D lumped mass matrix.

- More detail on mass matrix (it includes rotations)

Boundary conditions are set relative to a local coordinate system so that the symmetric boundary conditions at the endpoints of the struts.

Stresses and strains are calculated using the formula ??? [cite presentation]

Each beam element within the beam system is associated with a BeamElement object. The local stiffness and mass matrices are calculated with the solve_stiffness_matrix method.

Intrmediate values for displacements are found using the return_shape_functions, return_shape_functions and return_shape_functions_dynamic method. Intermediate values of stress and strain are

found using the `stress_strain_shape_function` method.

4.1.1 Beam Element Stress

[Discuss the stress shape function method?] [Cite the lecture idk]

Beam element failure is calculated for each element. The stress shape function for the beam is calculated and the maximum stress state between the starting node and the ending node of each element is found. Then the maximum between the two nodes is the maximum stress.

Stresses and strains are calculated with the `find_stresses`, `find_stresses_dynamic` and `find_stresses_transient` methods. The failure criterion is calculated in the `calc_failure_criterion_swt` method within the `BeamElement` class.

4.2 UAV Segment Model

A FEA model of single slice of the UAV frame was created. There are symmetric constraints at the midpoints of the strut beams. The center of the UAV is fixed in all 6 degrees of freedom. This assumes that the modes of frequency are symmetric. [maybe write about an asymmetric frequency model if I do that analysis] The arm and struts have an annular cross section. The hub is represented as a series of repeated I-beam cross sections. The width of each I-beam cross-section in the FEA model is the width at the centroid of the corresponding trapezoidal area of the hub.

4.3 Solvers

An FEA model was created with three separate solvers. The static solver, which is used to calculate the response given a static loading, the dynamic solver, which calculate the response given a force of an oscillating force at a given frequency, and the transient solver which calculates the response given a time-changing force.

4.3.1 Static

The static solver uses point loads calculate - Outputs - Stress - Explain how stress calculation is obtained - calculated from the local displacement in each element - Strain - Explain how strain calculation is obtained - calculated from the local displacement in each element - Natural Frequency

4.3.2 Dynamic

- Inputs - Point Loads - Frequency [Cite source] - Outputs - Stress Amplitude - calculated from the local displacement in each element - Strain Amplitude - calculated from the local displacement in each element - Natural Frequency

4.3.3 Transient

- Inputs Function describing a force at a given time - Uses Newmark integration to calculate resulting transient displacements and reactions - The transient stress is obtained from the transient displacements and reactions

The UAV segment model is generated in the DroneFEA class within the drone_fea module.

This module requires a DroneGeometry object as input. A BeamSystem object is generated to perform the FEA analysis. The nodes are generated using the `create_drone_slice_node` method which adds nodes to the BeamSystem object. The `create_drone_slice_beams` method calculates the hub section parameters and adds the beams to the BeamSystem object. The `boundary_conditions_slice` method applies the boundary conditions to the beam model.

4.4 Optimization

The problem is formulated as follows:

$$\min \text{mass}(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w)$$

subject to:

$$g_j(x) \leq 0; j = 0, 1, 2, \dots, J$$

$$x_i^L \leq x_i \leq x_i^U$$

design variables:

- d_a : arm diameter,
- t_a : arm thickness,
- d_s : strut diameter,
- t_s : strut thickness,

- r_s : strut distance from center,
- t_f : hub flange thickness,
- t_w : hub web thickness
- h_l : hub length

derived variables:

- d_{tip} : Deflection at tip
- σ_{max} : Maximum stress from bending
- f_{amp} : Amplitude of displacement at the tip of the uav arm
- D : Damage per mission
- E_{used} : Energy used over th duration of the mission
- E_{total} : Energy used over th duration of the mission

design parameters:

- $d_{allowable}$: Deflection allowable
- $\sigma_{allowable}$: Stress allowable from bending
- $R_{allowable}$: Allowable amplitude displacement ratio
- $n_{missions}$: number of missions before damage

Constraints:

Limit on deflection from bending by force required to lift the UAV.

$$g_1(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w, h_l) = d_{tip} \leq d_{allowable}$$

Limit on stress from bending by force required to lift the UAV.

$$g_2(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w, h_l) = \sigma_{max} \leq \sigma_{allowable}$$

Limit on amplitude of displacement given a forcing function based on the propeller speed of the UAV.

$$g_3(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w, h_l) = \frac{f_{amp}}{d_{tip}} \leq R_{allowable}$$

Limit on the damage the UAV during a mission.

$$g_4(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w, h_l) = D * n_{missions} \leq 1$$

Energy

$$g_5(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w, h_l) = E_{used}/E_{total} \leq 0.8$$

The bounds on design variable were determined by limits on commercially available carbon fiber based on the dragon plate website.

$$9\text{mm} \leq r_a \leq 50.0\text{mm}$$

$$0.254\text{mm} \leq t_a \leq 3.175\text{mm}$$

$$9\text{mm} \leq r_s \leq 50.0\text{mm}$$

$$0.254\text{mm} \leq t_s \leq 3.175\text{mm}$$

$$400\text{mm} \leq d_s \leq 1127.3\text{mm}$$

$$100\text{mm} \leq h_l \leq 1127.3\text{mm}$$

- Optimization algorithm used is SLSQP method using scipy's minimization function.

4.4.1 Objective Function and Design Variables

4.4.2 Optimization parameters

4.4.3 Constraints

Displacement

The static FEA solver was used to calculate the maximum displacement magnitude. To simulate the loading at hover, the loading is located at the

end of the UAV arm pointing upward while the center of the UAV is fixed in displacement and rotation. The load is a point load and is equivalent to the mass of the payload multiplied by gravity divided by the number of blades.

The formula for the constraint is shown in 4.4.3. d_{max} is the maximum displacement of the UAV.

[show figure of loading?]

$$g_1(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w) = d_{max} \leq d_{allowable}$$

Stress

The loading described for the displacement constraint was also used for the stress constraint. The static FEA solver was used. The allowable stress is determined by the maximum stress of the material and a factor of safety.

σ_{max} is the maximum nodal bending stress in the FEA beam system as calculated by the σ_{yield} .

$$g_2(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w) = \sigma_{max} \leq \sigma_{yield} * \text{FOS}$$

Frequency

The objective of the frequency constraint is to ensure that the frequency experienced by the propeller is not near the natural frequency of the vehicle.

Two analyses were done. The static analysis and the frequency analysis. The static analysis is equivalent to the on displacement constraint. A frequency analysis was done with a amplitude equivalent to the magnitude of the force in the static analysis. Formula 4.4.3 describes the ratio of the amplitude of displacement ($d_{amplitude}$) in the dynamic analysis to the resulting displacement of static analysis (d_{static}). The should be less than the allowable ratio ($R_{allowable}$). The magnitude of these force could be any number, the payload was chosen so the static analysis could be reused, saving computation time. [Justify??? Source???]

$$g_3(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w) = \frac{d_{amplitude}}{d_{static}} \leq R_{allowable}$$

The frequency of the oscillating loading function is described as two times the maximum rad/s of the propeller times the maximum percent throttle experienced during the mission profile. The forcing function is assumed to be twice propeller speed due to the propeller having two blades.

This is used for the frequency of the oscillating force for the dynamic solver.
The location of the force and boundary conditions are the same as the static analysis.

Damage

- Mission profile with 5s rev up rev down - Oscillating force based on propeller frequency - [figure of oscillating stress] - Raincounting

$$g_4(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w) = D * n_{missions} \leq 1$$

Energy

The energy constraint

$$g_5(d_a, t_a, d_s, t_s, r_s, t_f, t_w) = E_{used}/E_{total} \leq E_{\%remaining}$$

Chapter 5

Results

- The initial guess were based off of measurements from the original UAV design. - arm diameter, strut diameter, hub radius, flange thickness, and web thickness were all found to converge to boundary conditions
- Sensitivity analysis - The value of the design variables which did not converge to the boundary conditions were varied by $\pm 0.1\%$ of thier values to test the optimal solution.

Table 5.1

Chapter 6

Conclusions

Chapter 7

Summary

Bibliography

Appendices

Appendix A

First Appendix

A.1 Section one

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A.2 Section two

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Appendix B

Second Appendix

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